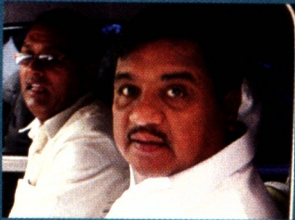




pumpkin patch



FOOT IN THEIR MOUTHS:
PATIL (ABOVE) AND NAQVI



AS IF ADMINISTRATIVE incompetence was not enough, India also suffered from cross-party verbal incontinence. It has meant that the title of Golden Pumpkin to be shared for the first time ever. Declared tied winners this week are Maharashtra's former deputy chief minister R.R. Patil and B.J.P. General Secretary Mukhtar Abbas Naqvi. Patil was a clear leader in the race for the Pumpkin when, during the terror attack on Mumbai, he declared that "small incidents like this do happen in big cities". When Naqvi chose to attack women "wearing lipstick and powder, holding candles and aping western culture and abusing politicians" instead of shouting slogans against Pakistan, it was clear—Patil had met his unfortunate equal.



LUCKNOW | Sniffing Them Out

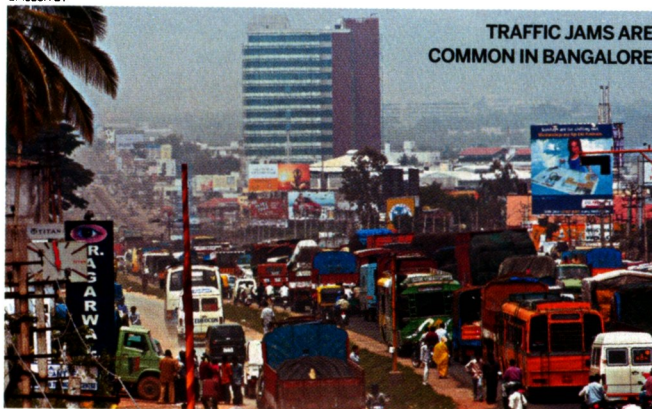
For the first time, sniffer dogs are being deployed to catch poachers and bust international gangs of wildlife product smugglers. Two German Shepherds have been trained to sniff out the skin and bones of endangered tigers and leopards. The two dogs, Don and Tiger, have been deployed at Dehradun and Lachchiwala railway station in Haryana respectively. Till now, dogs were only being used to sniff out explosives and drugs. The dogs were trained at Panchkula and a new batch is expected soon.

by Subhash Mishra



DOGS WILL BE USED
TO FIND POACHERS

GIREESH GV



TRAFFIC JAMS ARE
COMMON IN BANGALORE

BANGALORE | Pooling In

A citizen's initiative called Commute Easy, a plan to car pool and decongest Bangalore of its choking traffic, has grown into a major drive with the Bangalore city Traffic Police and a radio station joining on. Now called Let's Pool In, the drive aims at reducing vehicles in the city. Bangalore currently has 1,500 two-wheelers and 1,000 four-wheelers being registered each day. Bangalore, with a population of 60 lakh, has 32 lakh vehicles; Mumbai has 18 lakh vehicles for a population of 1.2 crore. *by Nirmala Ravindran*

200

crore rupees is the loss expected by airlines in Dec-Jan in the wake of the Mumbai attacks.

AHMEDABAD | Screen Shot

IIM-Ahmedabad has roped in Aamir Khan, Madhur Bhandarkar, Apoorva Lakhia and Sanjay Gadhvi to lecture students for a course called Contemporary Film Industry. Perhaps we can expect better managed movies now.

by Uday Mahurkar

